

Philipp Hilbert. *Trust infrastructure product manager for the agentic era.*

Positioning, a technical PM with a decade of delivery in regulated, ambiguous environments – now applying that precision to the problem of governed AI deployment.

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§ WHY AFFINIDI

Affinidi is attacking a problem that most AI infrastructure vendors are either too early to articulate or too late to solve: production-grade AI systems need verifiable identity and policy guardrails, not as an afterthought but as load-bearing architecture. The job description specifically calls out moving organisations from proof of concept to governed production – which is exactly the stage where product thinking, rather than engineering heroics, becomes the rate-limiting factor. You need someone who can hold the line between what's technically possible and what users will actually trust.

That is the gap where careful product work earns its keep.

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo refactors and spec generation
- **GitHub Copilot**, paired development and PR review
- **GPT**, research, edge-case generation, stakeholder drafts
- **Cursor / VSCode**, day-to-day coding environment
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **Framer**, design-heavy iteration and concept validation
- **n8n**, multi-agent and automation workflow design

- **Gamma.app**, structured stakeholder communication

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kotlin (Spring Boot), Python, Django, JavaScript, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redpanda, Kubernetes, Argo Workflows, ArgoCD, Helm, OpenShift, dbt, Dagster, DuckDB, Jenkins, Bitbucket, MicroStrategy, AngularJS, Ionic, CGM API integrations, REST APIs, GitOps pipelines, low-code insurance platforms.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CRYPTO BACKTESTING ENGINE [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

A personal infrastructure project for systematic strategy validation across centralised and decentralised venues.

- Ingests historical trade and order-book data from CEX and DEX sources including Hyperliquid and Bitget.
- Designed around a file-queue-based agent loop that separates data ingestion, signal generation, and execution simulation.
- Integrates liquidation heatmap data from Coinglass and Hyblock Capital to model market microstructure risk.
- Directly relevant to Affinidi's observability and audit-trail work: the architecture separates concerns cleanly so every decision step is attributable and replayable.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT AFFINIDI

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Sit with engineering to walk through the Trust Fabric architecture end-to-end – identity verification flows, policy enforcement points, observability hooks – and map where the current product definition is crisp versus where implementation trade-offs have been made implicitly.

WEEK 2

Sharpen the developer loop.

Identify the two or three integration friction points that block developers from reaching a working proof of concept, and write the first structured discovery artefacts: user stories with testable acceptance criteria, API contract sketches, and a rough sequencing of what unlocks what.

WEEK 3 +

Ship, validate, iterate.

Move the first incremental capability into users' hands – even a narrow slice – collect feedback against measurable outcomes, and close the first loop between what was specified, what was built, and what users actually encounter.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Affinidi team,

The Trust Fabric brief maps cleanly onto a problem I have spent the last two years inside from different angles: how do you make a complex, policy-sensitive platform legible enough that real organisations can deploy it with confidence rather than caution? At Rohde & Schwarz I owned the data management platform for a multinational defence AI programme, where SafeAI and ExplainableAI were not marketing terms but contractual obligations. Every dataset that entered an ML training pipeline needed a chain of custody: where it came from, what transformations had touched it, and what the audit trail looked like when an evaluator asked. That is structurally the same problem Affinidi is solving for AI agents – verifiable identity, traceable decisions, policy guardrails that hold under production load.

What I bring to a role like this is technical depth paired with delivery discipline. At Rohde & Schwarz I worked independently enough to unblock an infrastructure-level OpenShift issue that engineers had been deferring for over a year, then shipped the feature in one week. At the Federal Employment Agency I served concurrently as product manager and Deputy IT Security Officer, which meant holding security and compliance requirements inside the product process rather than treating them as a handoff. I am comfortable in technical discussions at the architecture level – not as a passenger but as a participant who can challenge assumptions, evaluate trade-offs, and write requirements that engineers find useful rather than decorative.

The job description asks for someone who is developer-obsessed. I take that seriously. The hardest part of building developer-facing infrastructure is that your users notice everything – missing error messages, inconsistent API behaviour, docs that don't match the actual response. At Emil Group I re-established delivery credibility on an InsurTech platform by introducing

structured refinement, splitting a 17-person team into focused Scrum units, and running weekly client workshops until the product felt trustworthy again. Trust is rebuilt in small, consistent steps, not in announcements. That instinct transfers directly to Affinidi's positioning: a Trust Fabric that developers adopt because it behaves predictably is the only version that scales.

The decentralised identity space is one I have been tracking from the infrastructure side. My crypto background is hands-on – wallets, bridges, DEXes, perpetuals, cross-chain risk – and it has given me a working mental model of what happens when trust assumptions are violated and fallback mechanisms matter. The parallels to verifiable credentials and decentralised identity infrastructure are not superficial; the failure modes are structurally similar. I understand why trustless systems are hard and what it takes to make them practical for users who are not cryptographers.

Berlin is my home base, and a hybrid model that combines focused office collaboration with deep work time is exactly how I operate best.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Technical Product Manager with nearly ten years of delivery experience in regulated, ambiguous environments: defence AI, public-sector analytics, InsurTech SaaS, and security infrastructure. Comfortable holding technical depth and product strategy simultaneously – reviewing architecture flows in the morning, aligning senior stakeholders in the afternoon, and closing a user story before end of day. Experienced working in environments where requirements evolve, trade-offs are real, and the product manager is expected to maintain momentum rather than wait for clarity to arrive. Brings AI-native workflows into daily execution as a matter of habit, not aspiration.

§ CORE STRENGTHS

- Translating complex technical systems into clear, actionable product requirements
- Delivery ownership end-to-end: discovery, specification, implementation support, rollout
- Developer-facing product design: APIs, integrations, and usability under the surface

- Technical stakeholder alignment across engineering, architecture, data science, and compliance
 - Security and audit product ownership: data provenance, access control, governance guardrails
 - Ambiguity management: structured problem decomposition under evolving priorities
 - AI-native execution: prototyping, LLM-assisted spec generation, autonomous feature delivery
 - Platform and infrastructure product thinking with strong scalability instincts
 - Founder pragmatism: low ego, high agency, strong bias toward working software
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§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ 2024, 2025

Product Manager, AI Data Transformation

- Owned data provenance, audit trails, and ExplainableAI transparency requirements for a multinational defence AI platform under the FCAS programme
- Delivered autonomous feature sets end-to-end: user stories, acceptance criteria, implementation support, testing, and GitOps-based rollout with ArgoCD
- Reduced deployment times from several days to 20–40 minutes by introducing GitOps pipelines
- Unblocked an OpenShift infrastructure issue independently that engineers had deferred for over a year – delivered the required feature in one week
- Led a cross-functional team spanning architect, data scientists, backend and frontend engineers, and QA with multinational stakeholder management
- Improved data quality through filtering, tagging, and reproducible transformation pipelines with full lineage tracking

FEDERAL EMPLOYMENT AGENCY (BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT) 2023, 2024

Product Manager, Public Data Analytics

- Delivered labour shortage analytics, flexible regional comparison tooling, and modernised admin features on the Arbeitsmarktmonitor platform
- Served as Deputy IT Security Officer, integrating compliance, governance, and data lineage requirements directly into the product process
- Introduced Dagster for automated ETL and indicator generation, replacing manual pipeline management
- Migrated legacy systems to Kubernetes; standardised CI/CD with full test integration at build time

- Designed interactive dashboards and community features for regional stakeholder groups

EMIL GROUP 2022, 2022

Product Manager, InsurTech SaaS Platform

- Delivered modules across product configuration, pricing, underwriting, policy issuance, document management, and workflow automation on a B2B InsurTech platform
- Designed and shipped a Claims Center module from concept to production rollout
- Re-established sprint discipline by splitting a 17-person team into focused Scrum units and reintroducing velocity tracking and structured refinement
- Regained client trust in a prototype-stage environment through structured weekly product workshops
- Reduced senior developer attrition from near-total to a single departure

CLINET PLATFORMS 2021, 2022

Product Owner, Mobile Healthcare App

- Delivered core patient-facing flows: digital anamnesis, meal and therapy plans, transport coordination, chat, and document storage across iOS and Android
- Integrated CGM interface into hospital information system workflows under tight delivery constraints
- Built stakeholder trust by surfacing technical complexity – legacy APIs, external database limitations – transparently and early

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

QCRYPT AG 2016, 2018

Product Owner & Deputy IT Security Officer

- Owned product architecture for a quantum-secure encryption product based on one-time-pad keys and true random number generator hardware
- Designed for non-technical users: setup under two minutes, no specialist knowledge required
- Served as deputy IT security officer with responsibility for attack vector mitigation and security governance

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS 2013, 2018

Founder & CFO

- Built a group-based P2P payment product on a P2P backbone from concept to mobile app prototype

- Owned PSP integration and full UX/UI design; product was later acquired and operated by Sparkasse

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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